

Tony Wang Li

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Research Interests

Human-Computer Interaction: I am interested in empowering people to tell their stories and surfacing their voices with technologists to build user empathy into human-centered AI products and services.

Education

- 2023–Present **Ph.D. in Computer Science and Engineering (Anticipated)**, *University of California, San Diego*, La Jolla, California
Advisor: Steven Dow
- 2021–2023 **M.S. in Human Centered Design and Engineering**, *University of Washington*, Seattle, Washington
Capstone Project: National Park Services Visitor Experience Data
- 2013–2017 **A.B. in Computer Science (Secondary in Statistics)**, *Harvard University*, Cambridge, Massachusetts
Senior Thesis: *Approaches to Policy Advice From Multiple Teachers in Reinforcement Learning*

Publications

- **Tony W. Li**, Zhiqing Wang, Thanh-Nha Tran, Grace Yu-Chun Yen, and Steven P. Dow. A Sensemaking Probe for Discussion Forums[†]. *In Submission*.
- **Tony W. Li**, Yunpeng Zhao, Yujin Zhang, R. Stuart Geiger, and Haojian Jin. Trust Label Design for Open Source Software[†]. *In Revision*.
- **Tony W. Li**, Arshia Arya, and Haojian Jin. Redesigning Privacy with User Feedback: The Case of Zoom Attendee Attention Tracking. *ACM CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems*. 2024.
- Yaqing Yang, **Tony W. Li**, and Haojian Jin. On the Feasibility of Predicting Users' Privacy Concerns using Contextual Labels and Personal Preferences. *ACM CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems*. 2024.
- Emelia May Hughes, Renee Wang, Perna Juneja, **Tony W. Li**, Tanushree Mitra, and Amy X. Zhang. Viblio: Introducing Credibility Signals and Citations to Video-Sharing Platforms. *ACM CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems*. 2024.
- **Tony W. Li**^{*}, Yelin Jo^{*}, Zander Brumbaugh, Hanna Lee, Michael Murray, and Elin A. Björling. **[Best Paper Award Winner]** Low-Effort, Unqualified, and Malicious User Behaviors in Online Human-Robot Interaction Studies. *ACM Special Interest Group on Design of Communication (SIGDOC)*. 2023.

- **Tony W. Li**, Michael Murray, Zander Brumbaugh, Hanna Lee, Raida Karim, Maya Cakmak, and Elin A. Björling. Tell Me About It: Adolescent Self-Disclosure with an Online Robot for Mental Health. *ACM/IEEE International Conference on Human-Robot Interaction (HRI)*. 2023.
- K. J. Kevin Feng, **Tony W. Li**, and Amy X. Zhang. Understanding Collaborative Practices and Tools of Professional UX Practitioners in Software Organizations. *ACM CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems*. 2023.
- Raida Karim, Edgar Lopez, Katelynn Oleson, **Tony W. Li**, Elin A. Björling, and Maya Cakmak. Share with Me: A Study on a Social Robot Collecting Mental Health Data. *International Conference on Social Robotics (ICSR)*. 2022.
- **Tony W. Li**, Ofra Amir, and Barbara Grosz. Approaches to Policy Advice From Multiple Teachers in Reinforcement Learning. *Digital Access to Scholarship at Harvard*. 2017.

† Title anonymized for publication review.

* Equal first-author contribution.

Honors and Awards

- 2024-2025 **Special Recognitions for Outstanding Reviews**, *ACM CHI*, *ACM CSCW*, *ACM IMWUT*
- 2024 **Department Service Award (Teaching)**, *Halicioğlu Data Science Institute*, UCSD
- 2023 **Best Paper Award**, *ACM Special Interest Group on Design of Communication (SIGDOC)*

Research Experience

- 07/2023–Present **Graduate Student Researcher**, *University of California, San Diego*, La Jolla, California
 - Currently conducting research on collecting individual and collective opinions and intelligence with Prof. Steven Dow (ProtoLab)
 - Conducted research on data privacy through human-computer interaction resulting in two published CHI papers, with Prof. Haojian Jin (Data Smith Lab)
- 05/2022–06/2023 **Graduate Research Assistant**, *University of Washington*, Seattle, Washington
 - Advisor: Amy Zhang (Social Futures Lab)
 - Surveyed user experience (UX) collaboration in practice and recommended tooling design from qualitative coding
 - Built crowdsourced video annotation tooling and evaluated with usability studies
- 09/2021–06/2023 **Graduate Research Assistant**, *University of Washington*, Seattle, Washington
 - Advisors: Elin Björling, Maya Cakmak (Project EMAR)
 - Developed software-hardware integration for a social robot and an end-user programming platform for intervention and measurement of adolescent stress based on user research
 - Evaluated online social robot interactions for adolescent mental health interventions through mixed-methods analyses
- 09/2022–06/2023 **Graduate Research Assistant**, *University of Washington*, Seattle, Washington
 - Advisors: Cecilia Aragon, Bernease Herman, Sarah Evans (Directed Research Group: Research Design for Games to Teach Data Ethics)
 - Evaluated and developed game designs for ethics and diversity education in data science

Work Experience

08/2017– **Data Engineer, Facebook**, Menlo Park, California

09/2021 *Artificial Intelligence Data Engineering*

- Partnered with Facebook AI Research to source and manage data for computer vision projects, platformize visual model-free data sampling methods for Instagram images, and visualize annotation progress in an interactive dashboard
- Partnered with AI Data team to analyze and improve Facebook AI platforms with previously no data architecture
- Implemented ETL data foundations, alerting capabilities, and data visualization dashboards to track reliability, performance, efficiency, and label quality across AI Data platforms
- Designed and implemented frontend UI for internal customers to track and analyze machine learning dataset quality

Ads Interfaces Data Engineering

- Partnered with Product Experience Analytics to promote advertising product quality and advertiser experience
- Created and maintained data ETL, central data pipelines, and data visualization dashboards for Ads org-wide goal metrics and internal Dogfooding Programs formerly with no goaling metrics or data visibility
- Implemented an automated bot to post weekly metric movements internally to relevant stakeholders
- Crafted and delivered presentations on query optimization and data visualization

04/2014– **Software Developer, Quorum Analytics**, Cambridge, Massachusetts

- 08/2015
- Built an online legislative strategy platform performing big data analysis of the United States Congress
 - As a full stack developer, created interactive data visualizations and quantitative profiles of political data

Teaching Experience

2024–2026 **Teaching Assistant, UC San Diego**

- Winter 2026 – *Online Database Analytics and Applications* (CSE 135): Created and led discussion sections, held office hours, graded assignments and exams
- Fall 2025 – *Software Engineering* (CSE 110): Mentored and advised project teams (60 students), created and conducted technical lab sections, graded assignments and projects
- Spring 2025 – *Software Engineering* (CSE 110): Mentored and advised project teams (70 students), graded assignments and projects
- Winter 2025 – *Startup Studio* (COGS 122): Managed four instructional assistants to grade assignments and projects, created and led interactive studio sections, and organized attendance and assignments
- Fall 2024 – *Software Engineering* (CSE 110): Created and led interactive lab sections for technical skills, created and hosted discussion sections for soft engineering skills, mentored project teams (90 students), held office hours, and graded assignments and projects
- Spring 2024 – [HDSI Department Service Award Recipient] *Systems for Scalable Analytics* (DSC 102): Held office hours and graded homework assignments

2018–2019 **Data Engineer, Facebook**

Lectured on data visualization and SQL query optimization within the data engineering organization

2017 **Teaching Fellow, Harvard University - Computer Science**

Advanced Topics in Data Science (CS109b): Held teaching office hours and graded homework assignments

Leadership and Service

- 2024–2026 **Peer Reviewer**, *3 Special Recognitions for Outstanding Reviews*, ACM CHI (5 full papers, 1 late-breaking work); ACM Computer-Supported Cooperative Work & Social Computing (CSCW); ACM Interactive, Mobile, Wearable and Ubiquitous Technologies (IMWUT)
- 2023–2025 **Student Volunteer**, *ACM CHI, ACM SIGDOC*
Assisted participant check-in, event setup, technical setup/cleanup, and general coordination
- 2025 **Local Arrangements Chair**, *ACM Collective Intelligence*
Managed local venues and partners for the conference, and coordinated with invited guest speakers for arrangements and accommodations
- 2025 **Co-Chair**, *UCSD Design Lab Impact and Student Culture Organization (DISCO)*
Budgeted, planned, and managed social events for the Design Lab graduate student population
- 2021–2023 **President**, *University of Washington HCDE Graduate Student Association*
Organized and coordinated social and professional events for 300 graduate students
- 2016–2017 **Design Director of Staff Development, Software Engineer**, *The Harvard Crimson*
Recruited designers for the school newspaper, lectured on design and web development skills, developed the newspaper's online website
- 2016–2017 **President**, *Harvard Chinese Music Ensemble*
Coordinated rehearsals and community performances with 8 members, performed on the *erhu* (traditional Chinese violin)

Technical Skills

- Programming Python, C/C++, Java
- Web HTML, CSS, JavaScript/React, PHP
- Data Analysis Python, SQL (MySQL, Hive/Spark, Presto), R
- User Research Interview, Survey, Usability Testing, Experimental Study Design, Design Prototyping (Figma, InDesign)